

parents rarely are **provoked**^① to wonder if they shouldn't have had kids, but ^②unhappy childless folks are bothered with the message that children are the single most important thing in the world: obviously their misery must be a direct result of the **gaping**^③ baby-size holes in their lives.

有失公平。不幸福的父母很少被激起对“自己是否本不该要孩子”的思考；但不幸福的无子女者会不断被“孩子是世界上唯一最重要的事情”这一信息所烦扰；显然他们的痛苦必定是他们生活中那些豁开的、孩子大小的窟窿所带来的直接后果。

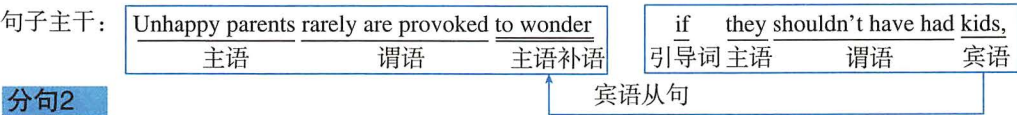
· 词汇注释与难句分析 ·

- ① **persistently** [pə'sistəntli] *ad.* 持续不断地
- ② **celebrate** ['selibreit] *v.* 颂扬
- ③ **procreation** [ˌprəʊkri'eɪʃən] *n.* 生育
- ④ **provoke** [prə'vəʊk] *v.* 煽动, 激励

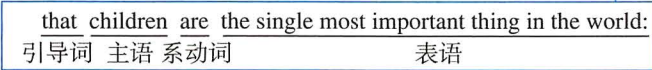
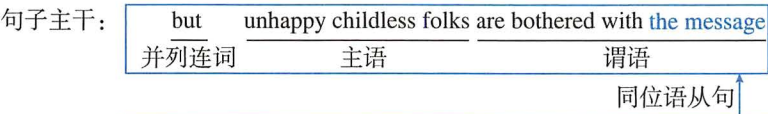
- ⑤ **gape** [geɪp] *v.* 张开; 裂开; 豁开
- **经典搭配**
- ① be equivalent to (等同于)
- ② be bothered with (受……困扰)

Unhappy parents rarely are provoked to wonder if they shouldn't have had kids, but unhappy childless folks are bothered with the message that children are the single most important thing in the world: obviously their misery must be a direct result of the gaping baby-size holes in their lives.

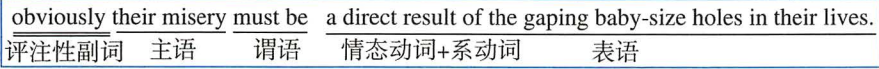
分句1



分句2



对冒号前分句的解释说明



功能注释: 本句主干为 but 连接的两个并列分句。第一个分句中 if 引导的从句做 wonder 的宾语、说明“不幸福的父母”很少被引发哪一方面的思考。第二个分句中 that 引导 message 的同位语从句, 其中句中冒号表示补充说明, 前后信息共同说明“不幸福的无子女者”经常被何种信息所烦扰。

· 语篇分析 ·

第三至五段打靶。第三段批驳媒体影响下社会育儿观的“不公平”。关键词: doesn't seem quite fair。

①句承上明确当下社会极力颂扬生育, 并揭示这种做法的偏执: 将育儿上升到道德问题。句中 so 具有双重功效: 一、回指, 明确上段所述现象的本质; 二、强调, 凸显当下社会对育儿的偏执 (persistently: continuing to do sth, especially in a way that is annoying and cannot be stopped“执意地”) 并暗示作者批判态度。反问句式 is it any wonder that...? (≈It is no wonder that...) 表达肯定: 在这种极力倡导生育的社会环境下, 将“后悔生儿育女”视为“赞同残杀小猫(这一道德沦丧之举)”毫不奇怪, 明确偏执程度。

②③句进一步揭示这种偏执社会育儿观中存在的“不公平”。

②句明确作者观点: 将“不幸福父母的遗憾”和“不幸福无子女者的遗憾”相较有失公平。then (“因此, 既然如此”) 体现因果强关联; doesn't seem quite fair 委婉客观地传达作者态度。③句通过对比外界对两者的不同态度, 说明为何将两者相较有失公允。rarely are provoked to wonder... VS are bothered